neutralise Pakistan's proxies and shape a Bangladeshi government for India's advantage.

Once he knew his cover had been blown, Singh decided to follow a routine to counter the 24/7 surveillance on him. Every evening when he left the embassy, he would go to a video cassette shop close to his residence, borrow a Hindi movie and go home. Every Friday, he shopped for vegetables and groceries. A week later, the Bangladeshi counterintelligence officials opened a vegetable stall in front of his house to intensify their surveillance, because it appeared to them that Singh was doing nothing to justify their eye on him. Unperturbed, Singh continued his routine. In September 1990, an informer within the Bangladeshi establishment told him that his file had been closed because the counterintelligence officials had found nothing suspicious about him.

'The Bangladeshi counterintelligence thought R.K. Singh was not a R&AW officer. He goes to same video shop every day, comes back home and goes nowhere else to meet contacts or possible assets. What operation could he run? So they turned their surveillance on a brigadier who was working as the defence attache at the embassy. R.K. Singh's four month long exercise in patience paid off, and now he was able to carry out spectacular operations in Bangladesh, crafting new alignments and informal networks to neutralise our adversaries,' chuckled Alok.

Indian spies also faced obstacles in Europe in the 1980s when Pakistan-linked forces became even more radical. In early 1981, it was learned that some Pakistani sympathisers based in London were raising funds for a Kashmir jihad. The R&AW used Prague as a launch pad to mount an operation against this